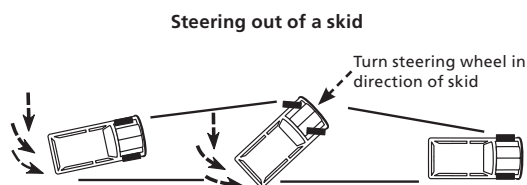


3. Avoid a situation that could cause a skid by slowing down when the road and weather conditions are poor. Also, check your car's tires. Old or worn tires that have minimal or damaged tread are dangerous. (In the illustration below, the direction of the skid is to the right.)



Brake Failure

If your car brakes fail, do not panic. Remember you can use your parking brake and shift to a lower gear. Apply your parking brake cautiously to keep from locking the brakes and throwing your car into a skid.

Running Off the Pavement

If something causes you to swerve and run off the pavement:

- Do not hit the brakes suddenly and hard. Grip the steering wheel tightly and take your foot off the gas pedal.
- Use your brakes carefully and do not swing back onto the pavement. Wait until your speed is reduced, check the traffic behind you, and then carefully drive back onto the pavement.

Flat Tire or Blowout

If you have a flat tire or a blowout:

- Do not hit the brakes suddenly and hard
- Take your foot off the gas pedal and gently apply the brakes
- Steer straight ahead to a stop

Driving Down a Steep Hill

When driving down a steep hill, you can shift your car into a low gear to help slow your vehicle. Never coast in neutral or for cars with a standard transmission, never coast with your foot on the clutch.

Winter Driving

Most drivers realize winter creates additional hazards, but many drivers don't know what to do about it. Here are a few precautions you should follow during winter.

Table 23: Winter Driving Safety Tips

Safety Tip	Explanation
Maintain a safe interval	Increase the distance from the vehicle ahead of you according to the conditions of the pavement. Many rear-end collisions occur on icy streets because drivers don't leave space to stop. Snow tires will slide on ice or packed snow. To keep safe, you must keep your distance.
Reduce speed to correspond with conditions	There is no such thing as a "safe" speed range at which you may drive on snow or ice. You must be extremely cautious until you are able to determine how much traction you can expect from your tires. Avoid locking of brakes on ice as it will cause a loss of steering and control. Every city block and every mile of highway may be different, depending upon sun or shade and the surface of the road.
Keep windows clear	Remove snow and ice before you drive, even if you're just driving a few miles. Make certain the windshield wipers and defroster are working properly.
Watch for danger spots ahead	There may be ice on bridges when the rest of the pavement is clear. Snow melts more slowly in shady areas. Take precautions when approaching turns.
Get a feel for the road	Start out very slowly. It is useless to burn the rubber off your tires by spinning the wheels. Test your brakes gently after the car is in motion to determine how much traction you have. Start slowing down before you come to a turn.
Equip your vehicle with chains or snow tires	Chains are the most effective and should be used where ice and snow remain on the road. One word of caution, neither chains nor snow tires will permit you to drive on slick pavement at normal speeds so don't get a false feeling of security.

Roundabouts

Modern Roundabout

A modern roundabout is a one-way, circular intersection where traffic flows counter clockwise around a center island. Modern roundabouts use yield signs rather than traffic lights to control vehicles entering the intersection. This intersection design only has eight potential conflict points, opposed to a traditional "four-way" signalized intersection which has 32 potential conflict points.